

FINAL ASSIGNMENT: CASE STUDY “The People’s Bank”

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BACKGROUND: This document has been created as partial requirements for obtaining ICP-ENT/ICP-CAT certifications as a demonstration of concepts learned via participation in the Enterprise Coach Mastercamp (March-April 2022) lead by Michael Spayed & Michael Hammam of The Collective Edge. More information:

<https://www.the-collective-edge.com/enterprise-coach-mastercamp>

CONTENTS:

- 1. Analysis of “People’s Bank” case study**
- 2. Initial Assessment Plan for client “People’s Bank”**
- 3. Initial Assessment Appendixes**

PART 1: Analysis of People's Bank Case

(Slides included as reference / context)

Case Study "You've been hired..."

• **Scenario:** You're hired before you know very much, except that the client is called *People's Credit Union*, and the sponsor bringing you in (Lynne) is a Senior Director in Technology. A 1200-person company, HQ in the midwest US. They have been doing Agile for several years. Hot button issue: raising the level of technology capability by hiring technologists and integrating this capability into the Agile process.

Ask yourself: What skills and competencies will you need in your role? What do you believe are the main functions of your role? How do you want to describe your job role to Lynne?

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18

Case Study A note from your sponsor...what she expects...

• **Scenario:** Lynne, Transformation Leader, tells you: We have been very focused on "people" all of these years. We started moving into internet banking late in the game and have recently realized that we really need to "up our game" in terms of technology if we're going to be seen as relevant; this means hiring certain skills, but also integrating them into our culture. We also really need to be more results-oriented and process focused around here.

She asks: How do you see this? Is there something else you think we need to focus on? Tell us about how you would help us solve this problem?

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20

Case Study Will it Shift the Culture?

Scenario: People's needs to become more technologically sophisticated, starting with hiring more technology savvy developers.

Your Task: How might adding technical practices into the culture shift the values of the organization? What other shifts in the culture might be required to accommodate the more Achievement-Orange values of these new developer's into People's culture? How might this be accomplished?

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19

What Type of Change is Wanted? Is Realistic?

Is this a **Transition**? Or is it a **Transformation**?

- Tactical vs. Strategic change
- Process-driven
 - Agile Ambition
- Culture-driven
- Leadership-driven (different way of thinking / managing)

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WHAT:

People's Bank presents a complex situation with a lot of potential opportunity for conflict but also learning. This could be an opportunity for connection, creative conflict, and growth if the right people are reached in the right way, and at the right time.

The Agile Transformation Manager has the feeling that they need to improve their technical skills so that they can better deliver to marketing stakeholder demands:

- They've been "doing" Agile for several years
- The perceived need is repeatedly stated as they need to hire more technical people or implement technology solutions

Lynn's stated objective(s) represent tactical change – and while it might be realistic, it might not achieve the results that would satisfy all parties:

- The CMO feels frustrated by the apparent inability of the IT team to deliver what she wants
- The IT team doesn't feel respected as experts (ie "order takers")

On both Marketing and IT – there is a claim of "people culture" being a priority – but also that the other stakeholders have a "just get it done" mentality.

As a transformation coach – it will be critical that I am able to facilitate sharing in group and individual processes that feel psychologically safe to the participants. Understanding the culture and the willingness of people to participate in group

Case Study Sensemaking from Two Perspectives

- **Scenario:** It is now a couple of weeks you've been at People's. Among the folks you've gotten to know, two key stakeholders are Shane, the CMO, and Lynne, who is Senior Director who is leading the Agile transformation effort. (Incidentally, Lynn reports to Brad, who is the CTO (and whom you have not yet met). Both Shane and Lynn have been with People's for 15 years, so they are veterans of that culture.
- What you've come to see is that Shane, from his marketing lens, simply wants to give his customers the technological apps they want; "just get it done" is something he is known to often say. Meanwhile, Lynne thinks the new technologists they hire are a difficult culture match for People's culture and often bristles at the "just get it done" mindset they seem to reflect, and she sees Shane as exemplifying.
- Shane and Lynne each tend to give you very different pictures of what's going on: what's hard, why it's hard, and so on. It can be really difficult to reconcile their radically differing perspectives and ways of making sense of things.
- **What would you do?** This difference might leave you in a difficult position, in terms of potential conflicts and their drastically differing perspectives. Can you see that there is not any single "right" perspective? There is nothing to do with this at this point, necessarily, except to notice it.

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29

processes will drive the selection of the group facilitation methodology.

HOW:

Rather than revealing to Shane & Lynne my personal, initial observations about their (apparent) contradictions, it might be more productive to *focus on what is working and shared values and goals*.

This would *permit people who think they are in opposition to develop a way forward without casting blame*. Keeping the discussions constructive and using information about conflicts or what doesn't work as parts of the puzzle – gathering more information to see the picture from all sides – including a variety of holons (individual, team, division) and levels (including seniority and tenure).

Facilitating without judgment or unsolicited expertise/advice will be very important to fostering an environment where the stated goals of people-focused consensus can reassert within the culture.

At this point, I am leaning toward Appreciative Inquiry or Future Search type of group facilitation processes for this organization.

Case Study Early Systems Entry & Contracting

- **Scenario:** You are beginning to get introduced to the major players. A description is below in the Notes section.
- **Your Task:** Who are the players in this system (including ones not explicitly mentioned)? Who do I need to "partner" with? Who might be the stakeholders? What is the nature of the initial conversations I need to have with these people in order to establish a working relationship?
- With whom do you need to contract? What contract elements need to be considered? Who might be missing (in terms of role in the organization or within the Agile environment)?

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30

WHO:

People's Bank does not lack diversity of opinions and perspectives. Including people from a variety of teams and levels is important – and respecting the initial request for help with "Agile transformation" within the IT team can be a great place to identify additional needs within the organization.

For example – they may have challenges with scope creep or changes after a sprint has started due to unclear requirements or a changing roadmap. There may not be strong product owners participating in the Agile process.

Everyone listed to the left has strong skills and vision to contribute to improving the way that they work. As a coach, it's my honor and pleasure to facilitate conversations and processes to help them see this for themselves.

- Sophie, the CEO - was hired in the last year; she is a visionary, a very adept leader, loves both technology and serving people, and believes the future is going to underserved markets in other countries, including microlending. She has a vision for an updated technology capability in the tradition of serving customers like family.
- Brad, CTO - has been with People's for 2 years, hired for his ability to lead in the technology space and for his strong leadership profile. He is committed to Agile.
- Shane, CMO - has worked with People's for 15 years, coming up through the ranks of bank teller, customer service rep, and branch manager, until moving into the chief marketing officer role, where he has a strong loyalty to the People's brand -- he feels lots of pressure to provide the new technology tools customer say they want, and

can be a bit hot-headed when his people don't give him what he wants quickly.

- Lynne, Senior Director - Lynne is leading the Agile Transformation effort and reports directly to Brad. She has been with People's for 15 years, and is very aligned with their culture. The new technologists can make her bristle with their attitude, but she is devoted to making this work.

Case Study Initial Integral Assessment (Homework)

- **Scenario:** So, you've been here for a while, and there are a number of pieces to the puzzle you're starting to see.... Here are some of those things....
- From conversations, you get the feeling that the business people don't trust IT to get it done (as represented by Shane's perception)
- From the many conversations you've had thus far, and observing dynamics in some of the meetings you've attended, you get the sense that IT tends to act as order takers, but are resentful of this.
- From a couple of conversations (with Lynne and a couple of Scrum Masters), and also based on the fact they're the ones who've brought you in... you get the feeling that IT managers are the main drivers of the Agile initiative.
- People's Credit Union is a "people" culture; they want to empower people, it's about consensus. And yet there's a tension with the newer IT folks who are a lot less "people" focused and simply want to "get stuff done". This generates a kind of cultural friction.

Identifying the core Agile transformation team to lead the initial assessment and participants from other divisions to be consulted / informed (see RACI in Appendixes) will help ensure inclusion of different teams in the information gathering phase and also define the impact on their time / responsibilities.

For example, Shane may not want to conduct the interviews but wants to ensure that her team's voices are heard and may want to review the kinds of questions that are being asked as part of the 1:1 interviews.

The Purpose of an **Organizational Assessment**

To discover:

- **Current status** of key dimensions of "focal" organization
- **Who** wants these dimensions to change, in **what way**, and **why**?
- How **ready** is the organizational system for such a change (**enablers** and **hindrances**)?

NOTE: When carrying out an assessment, it is a **collective sensemaking activity**.

WHY

The "Why" in this case can reflect multiple important questions:

- Why does People's Bank need to change?
- Why do we need to do an "Initial Assessment"?
- Why do we need YOU (enterprise coach) to do this?
- Why do I think that this is a good fit for the kind of change and leadership that I desire to foster in the world?

Some responses:

- People's Bank stakeholders all have a desire for change (even if only evidenced via complaint or dissatisfaction) – and despite some apparent contradictions or conflicts in perception, this is a good basis to bring them together
- The Initial Assessment will help to understand more about the pain points, the strengths and vision for the organization – and to empower / facilitate transparent, powerful discussions among the stakeholders as well as uncover the people most committed to change
- People's Bank doesn't need me specifically but having an outsider to support uncovering all the perspectives and "truths" and seeing their strengths may help them see that they can come together in more rewarding and effective ways.

The Tao of **Systems Entry**

Ask...

Who wants What, and Why?

Then determine...

- How Much will the What take?
- are the Who truly willing?
- and does their Why justify all this?

Finally decide...

- can the What actually be done, given their Who and How Much?
- is their Why a good match for your Why?

Else: run...

- If People's Bank has coaches or facilitators on staff already, they may be candidates to help with the follow-up phases or tasks identified in the initial assessment. The initial assessment may also help identify people who would be great facilitators, leaders, mediators, or coaches.

A Sense & Respond Approach to Change The Adaptive Action Paradigm



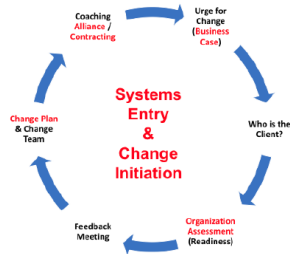
Adapted from Adaptive Action, Glenda Eoyang & Royce Holladay

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62

Systems Entry – a Systemic View

- Starts with an **urge to change**
- From this, we determine **who/what** is the system, and **what is trying to happen?**
- **Assessment** leads to a professional judgment: what type of change is the system ready for? Discuss in a feedback meeting with stakeholders.
- Based on results of the feedback meeting, we create a **coaching plan**
- We anchor the coaching plan through a **social contract**, establishing goals & boundaries



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79

Three “Theories” of Change

Type	Static	Dynamic	Dynamical
Nature	Deterministic (one-dimensional), subject to reward & punishment to motivate it.	Multiple dimensions make it complicated, but causality is one way.	Multiple forces act in unpredictable (but patterned) ways, generating surprising outcomes.
Path	Before and after; follow step by step instructions. Apply force as needed; only outcomes need to be monitored.	Know enough at the beginning to plan a predictable course.	You can't predict or control how change will happen, but you can set conditions (simple rules) to shape emergent change.
Measure	We measure the before and after to determine success.	We measure predictable developmental stages & milestones, subject to benchmarking.	Use Adaptive Action to detect changing system conditions; ongoing inquiry process across the system.

HOW

Using the Systems Entry model, we can create our initial assessment for People's Bank:

- Desire to change
- Identify “what” they want to change
- Assess their system(s) to identify how that “what” is represented and any additional changes that they may desire
- Create a coaching plan to help them implement their change(s) or go through the iterations and assessment at a later phase as a retrospective

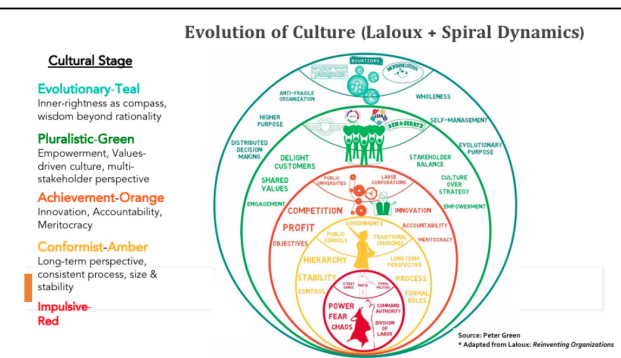
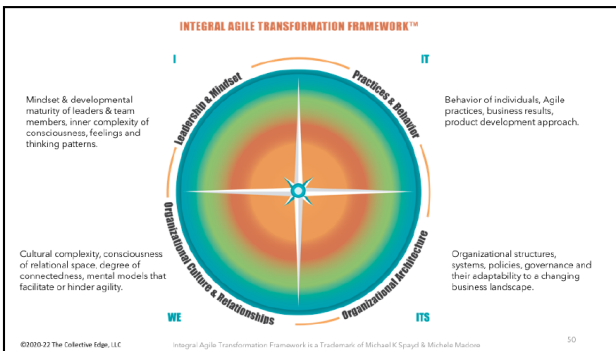
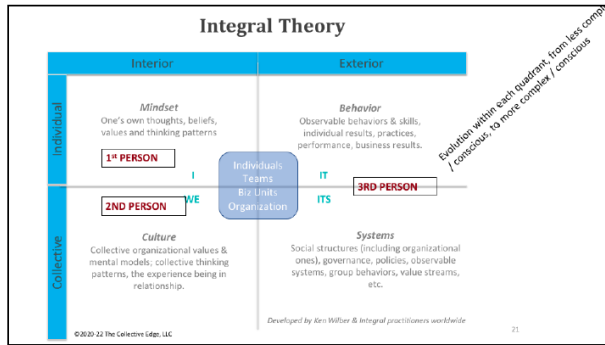
Sharing information about the sense & respond approach to change may help align the organization to an iterative approach.

“Agile” is sometimes seen as a “dirty” word in non-tech environments, but presenting a more generalized adaptive / iterative paradigm may be a gentler and more holistic approach for non-IT teams. It could be the framing of how the organization identifies change and evaluates success that makes all the difference.

Helping the transformation team understand some basic theories of change may be of interest (or they may already know heaps about this). It's a great topic to explore, and may present an opportunity to open discussions around the speed and depth of the transformation they expect.

WHY / HOW

Part of the information gathering phase should include some high-level information about how to gather information and collective sense-making.



Leadership (I)	Org Culture (WE)	Practices / Competencies (IT)	Org Architecture (ITS)
- Expect mainly Reactive /Expert leadership - Expect Reactive (Expert, Achiever) leadership - Tactical Intro of Coaching competency for goal clarification - Emerging Creative - Expect Achiever & Catalyst leadership - Coaching competency for growth of self	- Formal, role-based - Agile by edict - Expect "Competitive," Profit-driven (obsessed) - Team owns work (as long as biz goal met) - Values-driven - Teams own results - Participative, consensus - Family "feel"	- Iterative development "Simplistic" Kanban - Engineering Practices – measure biz goals (partial) Lean Startup - Kanban – cycle time - Results-driven Scrum - Team-oriented practices - Lean Startup practices - People-driven Scrum	- Matrix structure with empowered customer - Expect MBO structure & "rank & yank" - Look for "pain" - Flat org structure - Performance Revs done by Teams - Policies on rights of workers - Theory of Constraints
- Creative (Catalyst & above) - Coaching (multidimensional)	- Self-organized teams! - Purpose-driven culture - True meritocracy	- Lean Startup / Customer Development - Software Craftsman - Fluid code ownership - Unique solutions	- Innovative org structure - Holacracy, lattice - Team Coach role with no authority

Demonstrating the quadrants and the spiral models as a framework for understanding how the organization and different parts (or holons and containers) of the organization function.

My hope would be that this will help the participants in the group facilitated activities to understand the system better, and perhaps to have more compassion for themselves and others in this shared process.

Providing a basic baseline in integral methodology would give the participants the basic tools for understanding the importance of seeking information from different perspectives (quadrants or levels).

This methodology can also demonstrate a way of seeing how those behaviors show up for different types of containers – and as discussed in class – making it clear that many organizations are a mix and that awareness can facilitate making improvements that are beneficial across the system with *intention*.

Function	Traditional (Orange) Organizations	Emerging (Teal) Organizations
ORGANIZATION	Hierarchical pyramid	Self-organizing teams; coaches with no mgmt authority
PROJECTS	Heavy project management methods	No project mgrs; people self-staff projects
RECRUITMENT	Interviews by HR, matches job description	Interviews by future team members
JOB	Needs own description & title	No job titles; fluid, granular roles
PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT	Focus on individual performance; appraisal by supervisor	Focus on team performance; peer appraisals
PROMOTIONS	Jockeying for position, politics	No promotion, roles fluidly rearranged with peer agreement

Adapted from Reinventing Organizations, by Frederic Laloux

WHERE

I love this chart of what Agile looks like for different types of organizations. It can provide a great jumping off point to identify areas that can be changed to support goals and vision. Since “Green” organizations are not in this chart – that could provide an area for reflection and discussion that might result in identifying practical and aspirational goals for the organization.

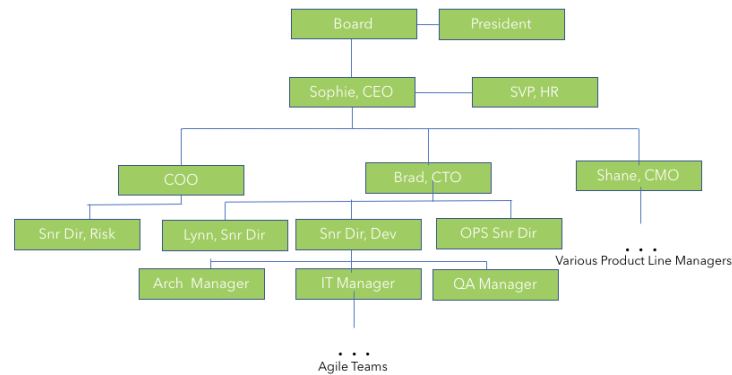
PART 2:

INITIAL ASSESSMENT PLAN: People's Bank

BACKGROUND: People's Bank has requested help with an agile transformation. The bank has approximately 1200 employees and is eager to streamline their processes to provide online banking products that will serve their clients. The team has requested support in driving an agile transformation to facilitate improved delivery of key products to market for their users.

Case Study

People's Credit Union: Partial Org Chart



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ENGAGEMENT CONTACTS:

Name:	Role
Lynn Hytes	Sr Director, Agile Transformation
Sophie Xeon	CEO (Executive Sponsor)
Janet Smith	SVP, HR
Brad Bender	CTO
Jenny Schechter	IT Program Manager / Scrum Master (Transformation Team)
Tina Kennard	Scrum Master (Transformation Team)
Divya Jones	COO
TBI	Sr Dir Risk
Shane McCutcheon	CMO
Bette Porter	Digital Marketing Manager
Dana Fairbanks	Global Strategic Marketing

APPROACH: An initial assessment phase will be conducted to identify areas for improvement in the current Agile processes. Interviews and facilitated workshops will be conducted to identify shared goals and desired outcomes.

ASSESSMENT PHASE: The purpose and goals of the assessment phase will determine the scope of the follow-up phases for this transformation:

- Identify key dimensions
- Current status of key dimensions
- Identify goals & desired outcomes across the organization as basis for group process activities to achieve organizational alignment
- Determine organizational readiness (enablers / hindrances) in achieving those outcomes

Modalities for the assessment will include:

Initial Information Gathering:

1. **Initial Interviews - Identify “Big Questions” or Challenges:**
 - a. Questions via writing / phone about what the client wants
 - b. In-person meeting to review stated goals, discuss pain points, perception of current state & ideal state “what would you want to do”
 - c. Identify team and build a RACI for internal reference (see sample RACI below)
 - d. Identify participants for interviews & for group processes (at least 3 levels of management & 3 different functional groups)
2. **Leadership & Team Assessment Tools** (with transformation team & leadership)
 - a. Discussion with organization’s experience with tools & frameworks
 - b. Review tools & frameworks, including but not limited to (Transformation Coach to modify based on initial interviews as needed):
 - i. Integral Agile Transformation Framework model – quadrants & levels (if appropriate)
 - ii. Containers-Differences-Exchanges Model (CDE)
 - iii. Agile & Lean Thinking principles, Adaptive Action Paradigm
 - c. Lead transformation team & leadership through strengths-based assessment tools such as Leadership Circle
3. **Agile Maturity Assessment survey** - a structured list of questions that cover all agile ceremonies and behaviors across current agile teams
4. **Define Interview Structure & Protocols:** identify interview subjects, confidentiality measures, briefing & decision responsibilities per RACI
5. **Define “terms of use”** -- Usage of assessment results & interview content
6. **Interviews with Agile teams and Marketing stakeholders** using structured questionnaires of Agile behaviors and ceremonies
7. **Examination of artifacts** including displays, team charters, user stories, tracking tools or automated Agile assessment tools, retrospective outcomes & recurring themes
8. **Gap Analysis:** training & coaching recommendations

9. **Group Facilitation Methodology:** Coach to work with the transformation team on recommended group facilitation methodologies, provide guidance on creation of facilitation guides and training (if needed).

Facilitated group processes:

1. **Findings Review:** presentation of the results of the initial information gathering (1 day)
2. **Vision & Transformation Workshops:** facilitated group activities for collecting feedback & aligning on vision and goals for FY 2022-2023 for change team and stakeholder group

Final Report & Planning: Assessment Results

1. Synthesize outcomes of Findings Review & Workshops
2. Define audience Assessment Results - how will they be used, how will confidentiality be protected, who will be briefed, who will make decisions based on the results, etc
3. Create plan for subsequent phases

APPENDIX A:

ASSESSMENT TEAM & RACI: This chart identifies how the team will work on the tasks of the initial assessment (to be finalized in initial meeting series)

RACI (Responsible, Accountable, Consult, Inform)

Name:	Agile Maturity Assessment	Define Interview Structure & Protocols	Stakeholder Interviews	Artifacts Review	Gap Analysis	Final Report
CEO / DVP HR / President	I	I	A	I	I	A
CTO	A	R	I	I	A	R
Lynn Transformation Team Lead	R	R / A	A	A	R	R
Tina Transformation Team	R	I	R	R	C	I
Jenny Transformation Team	R	I	R	R	C	I
CMO	C	R	C	I	R	R
Bette Marketing Transformation team	C	C	R	R	C	I
Dana Marketing Stakeholder	C	I	R	I	C	I

APPENDIX B:

Sample Group Facilitation Methods

Method Name / URL	Group Size	Requirements	Pro / Con
Open Space openspaceworld.org	20 + to ensure diversity	Group must be interested and committed; completely voluntary participation Non-informed participation (high level only) Space has to be comfortable – tables/chairs not required; large blank wall somewhere Time – 8 hours to 3 days Leader must trust the group to find its way (can't force specific outcomes or agenda)	PRO: some element of self-selection, higher probability that participants genuinely interested in learning Participants operate in small groups, self-organize per “law of two feet” – go to where you can contribute best Can be useful for generating specific outputs (defined by participants) such as a product roadmap or corporate vision CON: lack of structure or collaborative creation of agenda and desired outputs may not fit with groups that have a lot of conflict
World Café theworldcafe.com (PDF)	12 +	Advance planning helpful Informed participation Space must have tables – mix up groups, rotate to a new table and new faces every 20 minutes Paper for notes	PRO: structured approach that permits diversity of viewpoints to be shared Includes a reflective phase CON: more structured approach that requires advance invitations & planning may be more challenging to attract required diversity of participants in some environments
Future Search Futuresearch.net (methodology and an extensive sample plan)	60 – 100 people in a room	Task focused Time – half day sessions across 3-5 days	PRO: focus on “whole system” in the room Create common ground Treat problems/conflicts as information – explore context before solving any part Encourages self-management & responsibility for action CON:
Appreciative Inquiry – 4D model appreciativeinquiry.champlain.edu	Depends on scope of the inquiry	Advance planning – identify what kind of change is desired	PRO: focus on creating positive bonding & inquiry – focus on what's working and strengths Flexible – listen to people's stories in group or 1:1 discussions Group drives / shapes outcome / vision CON: process may require more time than some stakeholders are willing to commit

People

What kinds of people do I want to impact? Partner with?

Impact – people who are open to making change

Partner – people who want to facilitate rather than force changes

Role Models

Who are the world leaders (living or dead) that inspire me to be like them?

Not really sure tbh

I liked the leadership style of Ben Forta – vp of a group where I worked 7 years ago

What do I want to **Create**?

Opportunities for people to see each other and to recognize ways that they can make their work relationships better and as a result to improve their work products

Who do I want to **Be**?

A beacon – I want to be seen as a someone to help bring light to environments so that people can make decisions about how they want to proceed whether it's course correction or preparing the personal flotation devices

Organizations

How types of orgs do I want to work in, what do I envision helping them create?

Organizations that need help creating a way forward – whether it's a shared vision or even just preliminary awareness of their context / situation

World Context

How can my work help to make the world better in some small way?

Shifting people's reactivity and judgement to see their role in creating the reality around them

Practices

What are the practices, habits and behaviors I need to adopt (consider all quadrants)?

Flexibility & acceptance – not driving to personal goals that I set and accepting that other people have different goals

My Developmental Goal

(moving towards Outcome-
Creating)

Relationships

What type of relationships will support my growth? Who are the people specifically?

People with a growth mindset who are open and transparent, who can identify/own their own biases & motives. People who can share their experiences and challenge me to stretch.

Creating inclusive environments where people can be heard – give them opportunity to contribute

Structures

What kinds of agreements, accountabilities, conditions and constraints can I structure to support my growth (consider all quadrants)?

Accountability Partner:

Maybe Oluf Nissen - we work at the same organization, hit it off really well and I always learn something when we talk

Increase my training commitments; raise the quality of my reading list (and reduce time spent on pursuits that don't further my goals). Be with people who share similar goals.